

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Criminology (BA)

The Criminology Program is an interdisciplinary academic program, based primarily in criminology and sociology that studies the interrelationships among law, policy, and societal conditions. The relationships among these factors are dynamic and complex, therefore Criminology integrates a variety of perspectives, approaches, and social science disciplines in order to analyze and understand the origins of crime and injustice and society's response to these issues.

Mission Statement

The mission of the Criminology Program is to examine the causes and consequences of crime and crime control politics by providing a program of study involving a variety of perspectives, approaches, and social science disciplines to undergraduate students. Our faculty members are dedicated teachers and scholars who have published their work in the most prestigious journals in the field. They are committed to expanding the knowledge of the discipline and preparing students to be leaders in influencing our society's response to crime.

Majors in the Criminology Program at UT Dallas will be provided an educational experience, which will allow them to put their academic training, background and experience to use in a wide variety of post-graduate educational and occupational positions, including:

- Employment in Criminal Justice agencies at the federal, state, and local government level;
- Graduate School in Criminology or Criminal Justice (or a related social science discipline);
- Law School; or
- Social Work, Counseling, or other Human Service program.

Bachelor of Arts in Criminology

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)¹

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Bruce A. Jacobs, Lynne M. Vieraitis, John L. Worrall

Associate Professor: Tomislav Kovandzic

Assistant Professors: Michelle Harris, Andrew Krajewski, Yeung Jeom Lee

Clinical Professor: Elmer Polk

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours²

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

[COMM 1311](#) Survey of Oral and Technology-based Communication

[RHET 1302](#) Rhetoric

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[MATH 1306](#) College Algebra for the Non-Scientist

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[HUMA 1301](#) Exploration of the Humanities

[LIT 2331](#) Introduction to World Literature

[PHIL 1301](#) Introduction to Philosophy

[PHIL 2316](#) History of Philosophy I

[PHIL 2317](#) History of Philosophy II

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Choose one course from the following:

[CRIM 1301](#) Introduction to Criminal Justice^{3, 4}_—

[CRIM 1307](#) Introduction to Crime and Criminology^{3, 4}_—

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences⁴_—

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences⁴_—

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 60 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 15 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[CRIM 1301](#) Introduction to Criminal Justice^{3, 4}_—

[CRIM 1307](#) Introduction to Crime and Criminology^{3, 4}_—

[CRIM 2306](#) Criminal Law

[CRIM 2313](#) Police and Society

[CRIM 2316](#) Corrections

[CRIM 2317](#) Criminal Prosecution and Court Process

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences⁴

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences⁴

Major Core Courses: 24 semester credit hours

[CRIM 3300](#) Crime and Civil Liberties

[CRIM 3302](#) Advanced Criminology

[CRIM 3303](#) Advanced Criminal Justice

[CRIM 3310](#) Youth Crime and Justice

[CRIM 4311](#) Crime and Justice Policy

[CRIM 4322](#) Senior Research Seminar⁵

And Distributive Justice Focus

Choose one course from the following (3 semester credit hours):

[CRIM 3301](#) Theories of Justice³

[SOC 4369](#) Public Health and Society

[SOC 3325](#) Race and Ethnicity

[SOC 4302](#) Class, Status, and Power

[ECON 4333](#) Environmental Economics

And International or Comparative Focus

Choose one course from the following (3 semester credit hours):

[CRIM 3319](#) Comparative Justice Systems³

[ECON 3369](#) Political Economy of Terrorism

Major Related Upper-Division Elective Courses: 21 semester credit hours

21 semester credit hours of CRIM upper-division courses or related to CRIM

III. Elective Requirements: 18 semester credit hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower-and upper-division courses from any field of study. Students must complete at least 51 semester credit hours of upper-division courses to qualify for graduation.

Minor in Criminology: 18 semester credit hours

Required Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[CRIM 1301](#) Introduction to Criminal Justice

[CRIM 1307](#) Introduction to Crime and Criminology

Upper-Division Courses: 12 semester credit hours

Any CRIM upper-division courses excluding [CRIM 4V97](#), [CRIM 4V98](#), and [CRIM 4V99](#).

1. Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of UNIV 1010 and the corresponding school-related freshman seminar course. Students, including transfer students, who complete their core curriculum at UT Dallas must take UNIV 2020.
2. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.
3. Preferred course for Criminology Majors.
4. A Major requirement that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in Core Curriculum.
5. To be taken upon completion of Criminology major core courses.

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